

Buyer Consultation Guide

For New Realtors

Use this guide to structure a confident, professional buyer consultation from first contact to signed representation. It includes scripts, checklists, and follow-up workflows.

How to Use This Guide

- Review this before each buyer consultation until your process feels natural.
- Print one copy for your notes and one for your client packet.
- Customize scripts to your voice while keeping legal/contract details accurate.
- Always follow your brokerage policies and local/state laws.

Consultation Outcome Goals

By the end of the appointment, your buyer should feel informed, confident, and clear on next steps. You should have enough information to guide a focused home search.

- Build trust and establish your value.
- Understand timeline, budget, motivations, and non-negotiables.
- Educate them on financing, market reality, and offer strategy.
- Set communication expectations and touring process.
- Secure signed buyer representation agreement (when appropriate).

Pre-Consultation Checklist (24 hours before)

- Confirm date/time/location or virtual link.
- Send a short agenda so client knows what to expect.
- Ask buyer to bring pre-approval letter (if available).
- Prepare local market snapshot (prices, days on market, inventory).
- Prepare buyer intake form and note sheet.
- Prepare representation agreement and disclosure forms per brokerage.

Opening Script (2-3 minutes)

"Thank you for meeting with me today. My goal is to understand exactly what you need, walk you through how the process works, and build a plan so you can buy confidently. I'll answer every question and keep things clear and straightforward."

Set the Meeting Structure

- Discovery: goals, timeline, budget, preferences.
- Education: financing, market conditions, and process.
- Strategy: search plan, tour plan, offer plan.
- Next steps: task list and communication schedule.

Buyer Discovery Questions

Use open-ended questions first. Then narrow down to specifics.

1) Motivation and Timing

- What is driving your move right now?
- When ideally do you want to be in your new home?
- Is your timeline flexible or fixed?

2) Financial Readiness

- Have you spoken with a lender yet?
- What monthly payment range feels comfortable?
- Do you have funds set aside for down payment and closing costs?

3) Property Priorities

- Top 3 must-haves?
- Any deal-breakers?
- Preferred locations and commute limits?
- How important are schools, amenities, and neighborhood style?

4) Decision Dynamics

- Who is involved in the final decision?
- How quickly can you make decisions when you find the right home?

Agent Note Prompts

- Urgency level: low / medium / high
- Emotional motivators: space, schools, safety, investment, lifestyle
- Risk tolerance in competitive offer situations

Consultation Red Flags to Address Early

- No pre-approval + urgent timeline
- Wish list far outside budget
- Unrealistic expectations about pricing/negotiation
- Too many decision-makers with no single lead

Educating the Buyer: Core Talking Points

Financing

- Difference between pre-qualified and pre-approved.
- Why pre-approval strengthens offers.
- Cash-to-close: down payment + closing costs + reserves.

Market Conditions

- Current inventory and competition in target area.
- How days on market affects negotiation options.
- Importance of speed when new listings appear.

Offer Strategy

- Price, terms, and contingencies all matter.
- Inspection and appraisal considerations.
- Seller priorities: timeline, certainty, minimal friction.

Process Overview (Simple Timeline)

Search -> Tour -> Offer -> Negotiation -> Contract -> Due Diligence -> Loan Processing -> Appraisal -> Final Walkthrough -> Closing

Client-Friendly Script: Setting Expectations

"I'll guide you through every step and keep communication clear. My job is to help you avoid surprises, make strong decisions quickly, and protect your interests through closing."

Technology + Communication Plan

- How often listings are sent (daily/real-time alerts).
- Preferred contact method (text/call/email).
- Expected response windows for showings/offers.

Touring Standards

- Preview criteria before booking tours.
- Feedback form after each home.
- Prioritize homes that fit non-negotiables first.

Close the Consultation with Confidence

Close Script

"Based on what we discussed, I recommend we start in [areas] with a target price range of [range]. If you're ready, I'll set your listing alerts today, coordinate lender follow-up, and schedule your first tours."

Next Steps Checklist (Give to Buyer)

- Finalize/confirm pre-approval with lender.
- Review and sign representation paperwork (if applicable).
- Confirm target neighborhoods and non-negotiables.
- Set listing alert criteria.
- Book first tour block.

Agent Follow-Up (Within 24 hours)

- Send thank-you recap email/text.
- Attach key notes: goals, budget, search strategy, timeline.
- Send 3-5 starter listings.
- Coordinate lender call if needed.

Follow-Up Message Template

"Thanks again for meeting today. I'm excited to help you find the right home. Based on your goals, I've attached a quick recap and your next steps. I've also sent your first set of listings. Let's schedule tours for [day/time options]."

Consultation Packet Checklist

- Buyer process one-pager
- Neighborhood snapshot
- Sample closing cost estimate
- Offer strategy one-pager
- Your communication standards

Compliance Reminder

This guide is an educational framework. Always follow your brokerage policies, state licensing rules, contract requirements, and fair housing laws.

